

Charles Taragin

Economist

Curriculum Vitae

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Citizenship

United States

Experience

June 2019 - present **economist** Federal Trade Commission
Washington DC

- Work closely with attorneys and economists to model and quantify the effect of mergers and other potentially anti-competitive behavior.

September 2007 - May 2019 **economist** Antitrust Division, U.S. Department of Justice
Washington DC

- Work closely with attorneys to model and quantify the effect of mergers and other potentially anti-competitive behavior.
- Analyze the effects of various tariffs proposed by the Trump administration.
- Antitrust casework focuses on collusion and monopolization in financial markets, as well as merger analysis in the health insurance, advertising, airlines, and electricity industries.
- Authored code and documentation implementing numerous models to calibrate and simulate the effect of horizontal mergers. Versions of this code has been used in numerous antitrust investigations as well as in litigation.
- Authored code and documentation implementing numerous models to calibrate and simulate the effect of tariffs and quotas.
- Designed and coded web interfaces for merger and tariff simulation.
- Designed and maintained large databases (over 10 TB) for use in investigations and litigation.

Education

2007	PhD University of Michigan	Economics
2004	Masters University of Michigan	Economics
2000	Masters University of Chicago	Public Policy
1999	Bachelors University of Chicago	Economics

Presentations

5/2019	DC IO Day
4/2019	International Industrial Organization Conference
6/2018, 7/2018	Federal Trade Commission
2018	International Competition Network
2018	International Industrial Organization Conference
8/2018, 2013	Federal Communication Commission
2012, 2017	U.S. Department of Justice

Publications

1. Sheu, G., & Taragin, C. (2021). Simulating mergers in a vertical supply chain with bargaining. *The RAND Journal of Economics*, 52(3), 596–632. <https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1111/1756-2171.12385>
2. Froeb, L. M., Mares, V., Tschantz, S., & Taragin, C. (2018). The simple algebra of surplus in private values open auctions: A nested logit merger model. *Economics Bulletin*, 38(4), 2304–2312. <https://ideas.repec.org/a/eb/ecbull/eb-18-00431.html>
3. Froeb, L. M., Pittman, R. W., Taragin, C. S., Tschantz, S., & Werden, G. J. (2018). Economics at the Antitrust Division: 2017–2018. *Review of Industrial Organization*, 53(4), 637–651. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11151-018-9662-8>
4. Borzekowski, R., Thomadsen, R., & Taragin, C. (2009). Competition and price discrimination in the market for mailing lists. *QME*, 7(2), 147–179. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11129-009-9050-7>

Working Papers

1. Panhans, M., & Taragin, C. (2022). *Consequences of model choice in predicting horizontal merger effects*. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.14649.85603/1>
2. Sheu, G., Taragin, C., & Loudermilk, M. (2021). *Beyond “horizontal” and “vertical”: The welfare effects of complex integration*. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.31157.81127>
3. Taragin, C. (2020). *Evaluating CMCR under model uncertainty*. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.22231.50083/1>
4. Taragin, C., & Loudermilk, M. (2019). *Using measures of competitive harm for optimal screening of horizontal mergers*. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.30872.85760/1>

Papers In Progress

1. Taragin, C., & Loudermilk, M. (2019). *Ex-ante evaluation of merger harm using the 2nd score auction log odds ratio*.
2. Loudermilk, M., & Taragin, C. (2019). *Assessing the efficacy of the vGUPPI as a screening tool for vertical mergers*.
3. Hosken, D., Larson-Kester, M., & Taragin, C. (2022). *Mergers in labor and product markets*.
4. Taragin, C., Watkins, W., & Wallace, B. (2022). *Mergers and debt*.
5. Froeb, L., Taragin, C., & Taylor, C. (2022). *How the presence of strategic interactions among firms effects tariff outcomes*.

R Software Packages

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| 2021 | antitrust: Tools for Antitrust Practitioners <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ A collection of tools for antitrust practitioners, including the ability to calibrate different consumer demand systems and simulate the effects of mergers under different competitive regimes. |
| 2021 | competitiontoolbox: A Graphical User Interface for Antitrust and Trade Practitioners <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ A graphical user interface for simulating the effects of mergers, tariffs, and quotas under an assortment of different economic models. The interface is powered by the ‘Shiny’ web application framework from ‘RStudio’. |
| 2021 | trade: Tools for Trade Practitioners <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ A collection of tools for trade practitioners, including the ability to calibrate different consumer demand systems and simulate the effects of tariffs and quotas under different competitive regimes. These tools are derived from Anderson et al. (2001) <doi:10.1016/S0047-2727(00)00085-2> and Froeb et al. (2003) <doi:10.1016/S0304-4076(02)00166-5>. |

Service

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| 2018 | US DOJ/KFTC Knowledge Exchange Program <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ Organized, co-authored and co-taught a 3 day training program for new economists at the Korean Free Trade Commission (KFTC). The purpose of this program was to train KFTC economists in how to analyze horizontal mergers. |
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- 2017 **Algorithmic Document Review**
- Trained a series of machine learning classifiers to predict if a document is pertinent to an investigation. Once these models have been fully tested, they will greatly reduce the time needed to review the massive amount of documents received by the Antitrust Division.
- 2012 - present **R Training**
- Authored and co-taught a series of short courses for Economists and Research Analysts on R. Covered topics included: data analysis, plotting, regression analysis, mapping, interfacing with databases, and antitrust analysis.

Awards

- 2019 **EAG Management Award For Positive Externality**
- 2017 **Team Award for work on Anthem/Cigna litigation**
- 2016 **EAG Management Award For Extraordinary Achievement**
- 2015 **Team Award for work on National Cinemedia/Screenvision litigation**
- 2014 **Team Award for work on American/US Airways litigation**
- 2010 **EAG Management Award For Pushing Frontiers**

Computer Skills

Programming

- Python
- C++
- Java

Statistics

- R
- Stata
- SAS

Database

- PostgreSQL
- PostGIS
- MySQL
- Microsoft SQL

Markup

- Markdown
- LaTeX